GGG-C-800b
February 27, 1964

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. GGG-C-00800a (GSA-FSS)
December 5, 1962 and
Fed. Spec. GGG-C-800
August 9, 1956

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CUTTER, WIRE ROPE, HAND OPERATED

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers hand-operated wire-rope cutters used primarily in cutting plow steel wire rope such as that used for heavy hoisting on cranes or derricks, for anchor cables, towing hawsers, mooring lines, and general purpose rigging. This specification does not cover cutters for electric, telephone, or power cables.

1.1.1 *Federal specification coverage.* Federal specifications do not include all varieties of the commodity as indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those generally used by the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types, classes, styles, and designs.* Wire-rope cutters shall be of the following types, classes, styles, and designs, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I.—Hydraulic.
- Class 1.—Horizontal cutting.
- Class 2.—Vertical cutting.
  - Style A.—Normal duty.
    - Design a.—Self-contained.
    - Design b.—Remote control.
  - Style B.—Heavy duty.
    - Design a.—Wheel mounted.
    - Design b.—Stationary.

Type II.—Mechanical.
- Class 1.—Shear cutting.
  - Style A.—Normal duty.
  - Style B.—Heavy duty.
- Class 2.—Strand cutting.

Type III.—Impact (hammer action).

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification:

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, and Auburn, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-H-15424—Hand Tools; Packaging of.

MIL-L-15017—Lubricating Oil, Hydraulic.

Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Bureau of Standards Handbook:

H28—Screw-Thread Standards for Federal Services.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C., 20402.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Illustrations. The illustrations shown herein are for the convenience of identification and are not intended to preclude the purchase of wire-rope cutters which are otherwise in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

3.2 Material. The quality of materials, methods of manufacture, and heat-treatment of parts shall be such as to produce wire-rope cutters that meet the requirements of this specification.

3.3 Design. Wire-rope cutters shall be of the latest design, convenient to operate by one man, durable, and safe to operate at maximum speed. No part of the cutter shall become detached accidentally, during normal usage.

3.4 Fastening devices. Screws, pins, bolts, and other similar parts shall be installed with adequate means for preventing loss of proper tightness and adjustment.

3.4.1 *Screw threads.* Threaded parts shall be in accordance with the applicable requirements of National Bureau of Standards Handbook H28 and shall qualify as a class 2 or 3 fit in the coarse or fine thread series.

3.5 Hydraulic unit. The unit shall be capable of operation by continuous hand pumping and shall develop sufficient pressure to easily force the cutting blade through the maximum size wire rope for which the cutter is rated. A release valve shall be provided for positive returning of the cutting blade to its original position. Means shall be provided to prevent leakage of any kind from the system when operated in any normal working position under maximum working pressure, or when idle. Means shall be provided to prevent damage if pumping is continued after severing the wire rope.

3.5.1 *Hydraulic oil.* Hydraulic oil used in type I cutters shall conform to Military Symbol 2075-H or 2110-H of Military Specification MIL-L-15017. The hydraulic system shall be filled to normal operating level.

3.6 Cutting blade. Cutting blades shall be of high-grade tool steel properly hardened to a Rockwell C reading of between 58 and 66 (except for type III), and shall be easily removable for resharpening or replacement. The design shall be such that blades will cut clean, leaving the rope end free of jagged wire, and, except for type II, class 2, also minimizing the deformation of the original roundness of the rope.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.7 **Surface finish.** Castings, forgings, or molded or welded parts shall be thoroughly cleaned and shall be free of sand, scale, flux, fins, sprues, dirt, or other harmful or extraneous materials. External surfaces except cutting edges shall be free from sharp edges.

3.8 **Welding and brazing.** These processes shall be performed in accordance with good commercial practice. In no event shall such processes as peening or plugging be used on castings or forgings for reclaiming any parts of the cutter without authorization of the procuring agency.

3.9 **Painting.** Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), surfaces of cutters not otherwise plated or of corrosion-resisting material and for which a painted surface is suitable, shall be finished with one coat of good quality metal primer, followed with one coat of good quality enamel. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the color shall be that normally supplied by the manufacturer.

3.10 **Interchangeability.** All parts having the same manufacturer's part number shall be constructed to definite standards, tolerances, and clearances, in order that such parts may be completely interchangeable, replaced, or adjusted without requiring modification. Repair parts shall be of a quality equal to those originally used in the wire rope cutters.

3.11 **Identification marking.** Each wire-rope cutter shall be marked in a plain and permanent manner with the manufacturer's name or with a trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined. In addition, cutters shall be marked with the model designation and the capacity of wire rope in inches. When identification plates are used, the plates shall be of a noncorrosive material and securely fastened to the body of the tool.

3.12 **Type I. hydraulic.**

3.12.1 *Class* 1, *horizontal cutting.* Class 1 wire-rope cutters shall operate efficiently in a horizontal or vertical position and shall be suitable for use in the shop, field, and warehouse; on shipboard, and aloft. They shall be composed essentially of a self-contained hydraulic unit, cutting blade, rope holder and blade guides, and main body.

3.12.1.1 *Hydraulic unit.* The hydraulic unit shall be as specified in 3.5. In addition, it shall be compactly constructed, and the necessary valve and allied mechanism shall be entirely enclosed for protection against damage, dirt, and excessive wear. The unit for each size cutter (see table I) shall be capable of providing a minimum thrust of 12, 16, and 28 tons for sizes 1, 2, and 3, respectively.

3.12.1.2 *Cutting blade.* Cutting blades shall conform to the requirements of 3.6.

3.12.1.3 *Rope holder.* The holder shall be hinge-mounted and designed for simple, positive latching, or other suitable means provided for easily inserting the wire rope to be cut.

3.12.1.4 *Main body.* The main body shall incorporate the hydraulic unit and cutting blade, and means shall be provided for easily carrying the entire cutter with one hand. The underside of the body shall be suitably finished to prevent the tool from rocking under maximum load when operated on a flat surface.

3.12.1.5 *Cutting speeds.* The time required to cut the maximum sizes of plow steel wire rope during the performance test (see 4.3) and reset for another cut, shall not exceed 50, 80, and 120 seconds for cutters having maximum rated capacities of 3/4, 1-1/8, and 1-3/4 inches, respectively.

3.12.1.6 The hydraulic, horizontal cutting blade cutters shall conform to table I for the size specified (see 6.2) and be similar to figure 1.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I.—*Type I, class 1, hydraulic, horizontal cutting, wire-rope cutters*

Size number	Capacity range of wire rope diameter	Weight (max.)	Overall dimensions		
			Length (max.)	Height (max.)	Width (max.)
	Inches	*Pounds*	*Inches*	*Inches*	*Inches*
1	0—3/4	22	13-1/2	6	4-1/4
2	0—1-1/8	32	15	7	4-1/2
3	0—1-3/4	62	19	8	5-1/4

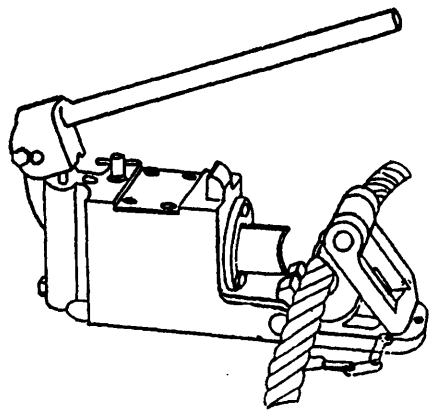


FIGURE 1.—Type I, class 1, hydraulic, horizontal cutting, wire-rope cutter.

3.12.2 *Class 2, vertical cutting.*

3.12.2.1 *Style A, normal duty.* Style A wire-rope cutters shall be suitable for cutting wire rope up to 1-1/4 inches in diameter for use in the shop, field, warehouse, or on shipboard. They shall be composed essentially of a hydraulic unit, cutting blade, rope holder and main frame.

3.12.2.1.1 *Hydraulic unit.* The hydraulic unit shall be as specified in 3.5. The unit shall be constructed in such a manner that the necessary valves and allied mechanism will be sufficiently enclosed for protection against damage, dirt, and excessive wear. The units for both the self-contained (design a) and the remote control (design b) shall be capable of providing a minimum thrust of 20 tons.

3.12.2.1.2 *Cutting blade.* Cutting blades shall conform to the requirements of 3.6.

3.12.2.1.3 *Rope holder.* The rope holder shall conform to the requirements of 3.12.1.3.

3.12.2.1.4 *Main frame.* The main frame shall be composed of forgings and high-tensile steel castings. The underside of the frame shall be suitably finished to prevent the cutter from rocking under maximum load when operated on a flat surface. A suitable handle shall be securely attached to the frame or body of the tool for carrying with one hand.

3.12.2.1.5 *Cutting speed.* The time required to cut 1-1/4-inch-diameter plow-steel wire rope during the performance test (see 4.3) and reset for another cut, shall not exceed 90 seconds.

3.12.2.1.6 *Weight.* The weight of the complete cutter shall not exceed 48 pounds.

3.12.2.1.7 *Design a, self-contained.* Design a cutters shall be furnished with a self-contained hydraulic unit and shall operate efficiently in a normal vertical position. They shall be similar to figure 2.

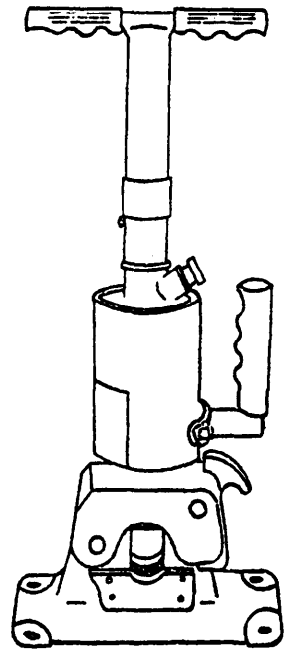


FIGURE 2.—Type I, class 2, style A, design a, hydraulic, vertical cutting, normal duty, self-contained, wire-rope cutter.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.12.2.1.8 *Design "b," remote control.* Design "b" cutters shall be furnished with a separate hand pump and hose instead of with a self-contained hydraulic unit. The hose shall be of heavy duty hydraulic type, shall be oil-resistant, and shall be equipped with a quick coupling. Both ends of the hose shall have coiled spring wire guards of sufficient length to protect the hose from damage. The hose shall be 6 feet long, plus or minus 6 inches. The cutters shall operate efficiently in overhead and horizontal as well as vertical positions. They shall be similar to figure 3.

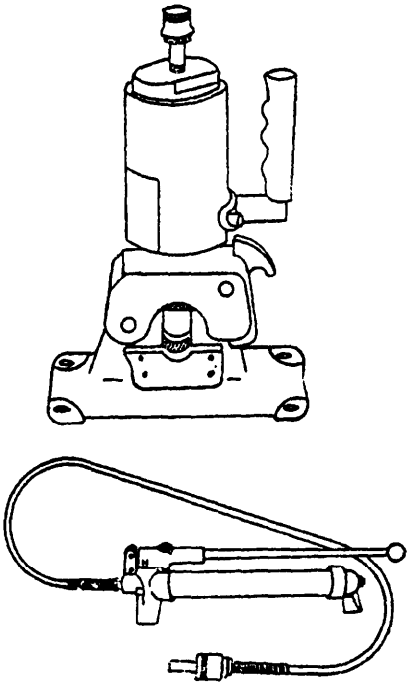


FIGURE 3.—Type I, class 2, style A, design b, hydraulic, vertical cutting, normal duty, remote control, wire-rope cutter.

3.12.2.2 *Style B, heavy duty.* Style B wire-rope cutters shall be suitable for use in the shop, field, or warehouse for cutting wire rope up to 2-1/2 inches in diameter. They shall be composed essentially of a hydraulic unit, cutting blades, main frame, rack and pinion, and rope-guide supporting roller.

3.12.2.2.1 *Hydraulic unit.* The hydraulic unit shall conform to the requirements of 3.5 and shall be constructed in such a manner that the valves and allied mechanism will be sufficiently enclosed for protection against damage, entrance of foreign matter, and excessive wear. The unit shall be capable of providing a minimum thrust of 70 tons.

3.12.2.2.2 *Cutting blades.* Cutting blades shall conform to the requirements of 3.6.

3.12.2.2.3 *Main frame.* The main frame shall be of steel and of rugged, compact design. The base of the frame shall be provided with four bolt holes for mounting rigidly on a bench, small portable truck, or other support.

3.12.2.2.4 *Rack and pinion.* A suitable rack and pinion shall be provided for bringing the upper cutting blade to or from the work without using the hand pump.

3.12.2.2.5 *Rope guide supporting roller.* A suitable roller shall be securely attached to the frame or mounted in such a manner that it will support and act as a guide for the wire rope during the cutting operation.

3.12.2.2.6 *Design a, wheel mounted.* Design "a" cutters shall be mounted on a small portable truck of rigid metal construction. The wheels shall be of rugged design and of sufficient size to enable one man to move the tools easily across floors or piers having crevices up to 3/4-inch wide. The weight of the cutter (not including the portable truck) shall not exceed 650 pounds. Design "a" cutters shall be similar to figure 4.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

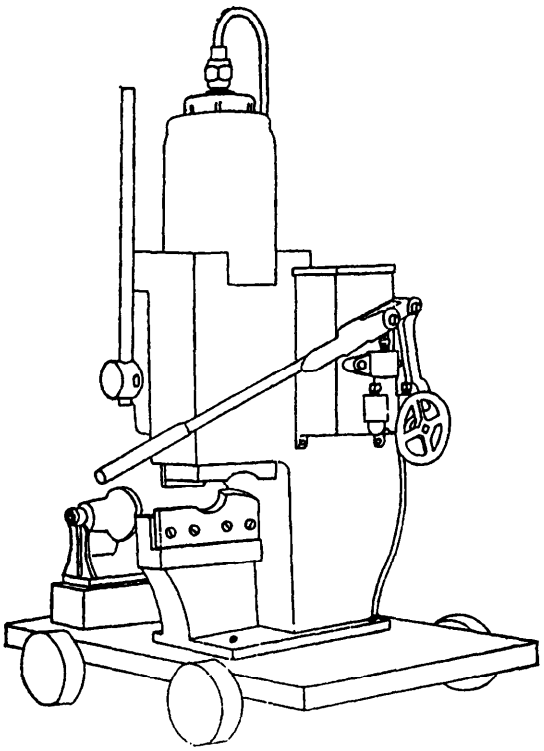


FIGURE 4.—Type I, class 2, style B, hydraulic, vertical cutting, heavy duty wire-rope cutter.

3.12.2.2.7 *Design "b", stationary.* Design "b" cutters shall conform to the requirements of 3.12.2.2 except they shall not be furnished with a portable truck.

3.13 Type II, mechanical.

3.13.1 *Class* 1, *shear cutting.* Class 1 cutters shall have cutting blades which utilize a scissor action in severing the wire rope.

3.13.1.1 *Style A, normal duty.* Style A cutters shall be suitable for mounting on a bench or other support and shall have such mechanical advantage as to enable one person to easily cut 1-1/4-inch diameter and smaller sizes of wire rope. They shall be composed essentially of a body, side or swing unit, cutting blades, handle lever, pivot bolts, and other necessary parts.

3.13.1.1.1 *Body.* The body shall be of cast steel or malleable iron and of rugged construction. The base shall have 4 bolt holes for mounting securely.

3.13.1.1.2 *Side or swing unit.* The side or swing unit shall be of cast steel or malleable iron and of rugged construction.

3.13.1.1.3 *Cutting blades.* The cutting blades shall conform to the requirements of 3.6.

3.13.1.1.4 *Handle lever.* The handle lever shall be of steel and shall have sufficient strength to preclude deformation when cutting the maximum size wire rope. The length of the handle lever shall be approximately 3 feet long.

3.13.1.1.5 *Pivot bolts.* The bolts shall be of high-grade steel properly finished, and of such sizes as to withstand excessive wear or deformation under maximum usage. Adequate means shall be provided for preventing loss of proper tightness during normal use of the cutter. The bolts shall fit the reamed holes in the body and swing unit in such a manner that satisfactory performance of the tool will not be adversely affected.

3.13.1.1.6 *Weight.* Weight of style A cutters shall not exceed 150 pounds.

3.13.1.1.7 *Lubrication.* Means shall be provided for lubricating the bearings.

3.13.1.1.8 The cutters shall be similar to figure 5.

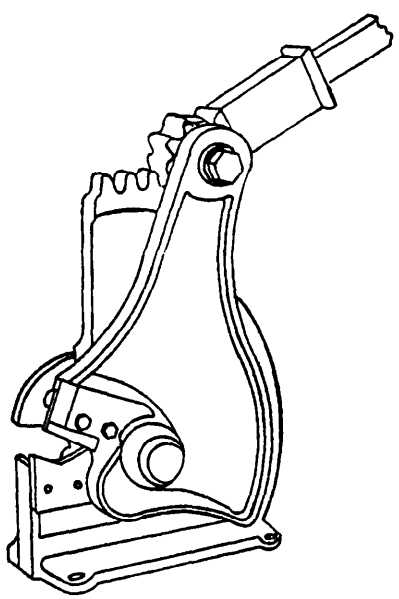


FIGURE 5.—Type II, class 1, style A, mechanical, shear cutting, normal duty, wire rope cutter.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.13.1.2 *Style B, heavy duty.* Style B wire-rope cutters shall be suitable for use in the shop or warehouse or on piers for cutting wire rope up to 2-1/4 inches in diameter. The cutter shall be composed essentially of shear jaw bodies mounted on three wheels, shear blades, and a mechanical pressure mechanism.

3.13.1.2.1 *Shear jaw bodies.* The shear jaw bodies shall provide safe and durable means for mounting the shear blades and the pressure mechanism.

3.13.1.2.2 *Wheels.* Wheels shall be of rugged design and of sufficient size to enable one man to move the cutter easily across floors or piers having crevices up to 3/4 inch wide. The two front wheels shall have adequate axle bearing surfaces and shall be mounted on steel axles of sufficient size to prevent misalignment after long use. The rear wheel shall be of the swivel type and the size and mounting shall be sufficiently rugged to insure long satisfactory service. Wheels and swivels shall not loosen or tighten under service conditions, and shall be easily removable and replaceable when desired.

3.13.1.2.3 *Shear blades.* The shear blades shall conform to the requirements of 3.6.

3.13.1.2.4 *Mechanical pressure mechanism.* The pressure mechanism shall be designed to exert a pressure between the shear blades up to 60 tons without risk of failure. The mechanism may consist of a ratchet drum, wire rope, ratchet lever, pawls, drum lever, cam, and sufficient sheaves with axles, or other equally suitable means, in order that the required pressure may be easily developed by one man.

3.13.1.2.5 *Cutting speed.* The time required to cut 2-1/4-inch-diameter plow-steel wire rope during the performance test (see 4.3) and reset for another cut, shall not exceed 6 minutes.

3.13.1.2.6 *Weight and length.* The weight of the complete cutter shall not exceed 275 pounds, and the overall length shall not exceed 45 inches.

3.13.1.2.7 *Lubrication.* All bearings for the wheels, main pivot bolt, drum, and sheaves shall be provided with pressure lubricating fittings or other adequate means of lubricating.

3.13.1.2.8 *Pivot bolt.* The pivot bolt shall conform to the requirements of 3.13.1.1.5.

3.13.1.2.9 The cutters shall be similar to figure 6.

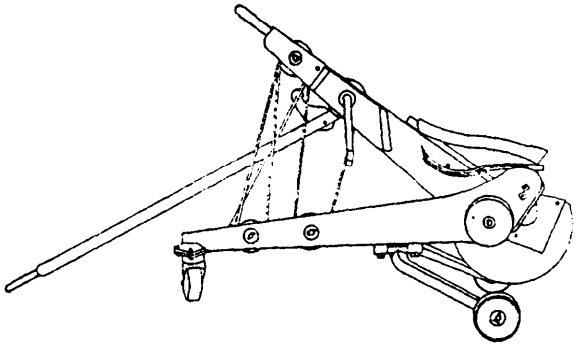


FIGURE 6.—Type II, class 1, style B, mechanical, shear cutting, heavy duty, wire-rope cutter.

3.13.2 *Class 2, strand cutting.* Class 2 wire rope cutters shall be designed for clipping strands from wire rope up to 1-1/4 inches in diameter, after cable splicing operations. They shall be composed essentially of handles incorporating a mechanical mechanism and cutting blades.

3.13.2.1 *Handles.* The handles shall consist of two lever arms with a mechanism of such mechanical advantage that a workman of average strength can cut wire rope up to 7/16 inch in diameter. The grip end of the handles shall be shaped to fit comfortably in the hands. Sufficient clearance between the handle grips shall be provided to assure protection of the hands when making heavy cuts.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.13.2.2 *Cutting blade.* The blades shall conform to 3.6 and shall be suitable for flush- or close-cutting. The cutting edges shall be not less than 1-1/2 inches long.

3.13.2.3 *Weight and length.* The weight of the wire rope cutter shall not exceed 17-1/2 pounds and the length shall be approximately 36 inches overall.

3.13.2.4 The wire rope cutters shall be similar to figure 7.

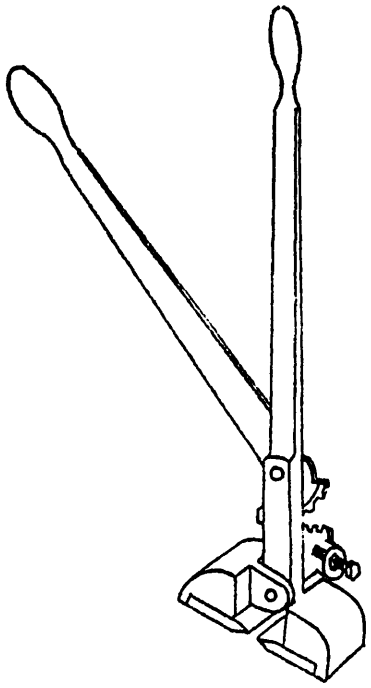


FIGURE 7.—Type II, class 2, mechanical, strand cutting wire-rope cutter.

3.14 **Type III, impact (hammer action).** Type III wire-rope cutters shall be suitable for cutting wire rope by striking with a sledge or heavy hand hammer. They shall consist essentially of a body and base, plunger, cutting blade, and die.

3.14.1 *Body and base.* The body and base shall be of one-piece malleable iron or steel casting having a heavy rib support and carrying handle. The upper part of the body shall have a reamed hole to provide a standard sliding fit with the plunger. The axis of the hole shall be approximately 90 degrees with the underside of the base. The base shall be suitably finished to prevent rocking when the base is set upon a flat surface. The base of cutter sizes No. 2 and 3 (see table II) shall have three counterbored bolt holes that can be used for securely mounting the cutter on a firm support or foundation when desired.

3.14.2 *Plunger.* The plunger shall be of steel, properly rounded to a crown shape and hardened to resist mushrooming or chipping, and shall not bind in the reamed hole of the body as a result of hard usage. Means shall be provided for mounting the cutting blade in the plunger in such a manner that it will not become detached during hard use. The plunger shall have a longitudinal keyway or other suitable means provided to prevent rotation of the plunger or misalignment of the cutting blade.

3.14.3 *Cutting blade.* The cutting blade shall conform to the requirements of 3.6 except it shall be hardened to a Rockwell C reading of between 56 and 58 and the cutting edge shall be shaped to the contour of the largest diameter wire rope for which the cutter is designed, to aid in retaining the original roundness of the wire rope.

3.14.4 *Die.* The die shall be shaped to fit the contour of the wire rope as specified for the cutting blade. The die shall be of high grade tool steel sufficiently hardened to withstand long use and securely fastened in the upper side of the base directly in line with the descending cutting blade.

3.14.5 Type III wire-rope cutters shall be available in three sizes and shall conform to table II for the size specified (see 6.2). Size No. 1 is designed for carrying in a tool kit for occasional cutting, and although its capacity is 1-inch diameter wire rope, it is not designed to withstand continuous cutting of over 5/8-inch diameter. Sizes No. 2 and 3 are designed for heavy duty and extra heavy duty, respectively.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II.—*Type III, impact (hammer action), wire rope cutters*

Size number	Capacity range of wire rope diameter	Weight (max.)	Closed height (max.)	Base diameter	
				Minimum	Maximum
	Inches	*Pounds*	*Inches*	*Inches*	*Inches*
1	[1]0—1	10	6-3/4	3	3-3/4
2	0—1-1/16	20	7-1/4	5-3/4	6-1/4
3	0—1-1/2	38	9-1/4	7	8

[1] Occasional cutting only of wire rope over 5/8-inch diameter.

3.14.6 The wire rope cutters shall be similar to figure 8.

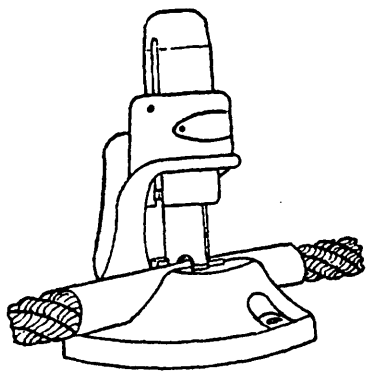


FIGURE 8.—Type III, impact (hammer action), wire-rope cutter.

3.15 **Operating and service instruction sheets.** Unless otherwise specified, each wire-rope cutter shall be furnished with two printed copies of operating and service instructions (see 6.2).

3.16 **Workmanship.** Wire-rope cutters shall be free from fins, burrs, sharp edges, and imperfections of any nature which may adversely affect their durability and serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 **Inspection responsibility.** Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 **Sampling for inspection and acceptance.** Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated herein.

4.2.1 *Inspection of materials and components.* In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that materials and components used were manufactured, tested and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards, or, if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2.2 *Visual examination.* Visual examination of the cutter assemblies or components shall be in accordance with the classification of defects as specified in table III. The inspection level shall be level II, with an acceptable quality level of 2.5 for major defects and 6.5 for total defects, expressed in defects per hundred units.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE III.—*Classification of defects*

Examine	Defect	Major	Minor
Material	Sand, scale, fins, sprues, or other foreign material not removed from castings or forgings		X
	Evidence of unauthorized peening or plugging	X	
Design	Not type, class, style, design or size specified	X	
Construction and workmanship (applicable to all components and assemblies)	Component missing, incomplete or operation missing	X	
	Component inoperative or will not function as intended	X	
	Fins, burrs, slivers, or foreign material or sharp edges (except cutting edge) not removed		X
	Blades not properly sharpened or easily interchangeable ..		X
	Fastening devices not provided with means of locking to prevent loss of parts or adjustment	X	
	Parts not interchangeable	X	
Rivets	Missing, loose, broken or inadequately peened		X
Bolts, nuts and other types of threaded components	Missing, broken, stripped or fractured		X
Surface finish	Missing, incomplete or not as specified		X
Welding and brazing (when applicable)	Missing, incomplete, poor penetration, cracked, porous or contains foreign material	X	
Assembly	Hydraulic system leaks	X	
	Component not properly assembled, affecting serviceability, e.g., crossed threads, loose or tight adjustments	X	
	Weight exceeds maximum specified One cutter from each lot shall be weighed to determine if design of cutter is within maximum allowable limits and used as a visual comparison for rest of the sample	X	
Marking	Missing, illegible, incorrect or not permanent		X

4.2.3 *Dimensional examination.* Each of the sample cutter assemblies or components shall be inspected to determine compliance with dimensions specified in applicable paragraphs. Any deviation from specified requirements shall constitute a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of cutter assemblies or components. The sample unit shall be one cutter assembly or component. The inspection level shall be level I with an acceptable quality level of 6.5 defects per hundred units.

4.2.4 *Testing.* Each of the sample cutter assemblies or components shall be tested to determine compliance with characteristics specified in 4.3.1 through 4.3.2.5 as applicable. The lot size shall be expressed in units of cutter assemblies or components. The sample unit shall be one cutter assembly or component. The inspection level shall be L6 with an acceptable quality level of 2.5 defects per hundred units.

4.2.5 *Inspection of preparation for delivery.* Unless otherwise specified, inspection to determine compliance with the preparation of delivery requirements shall be accomplished in accordance with MIL-H-15424.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3 Test procedures (at place of manufacture).

4.3.1 *Hardness test.* Cutting blades of cutters taken in accordance with 4.2.3.3 shall be tested to determine conformance with 3.6 and 3.14.3, as applicable, the reading to be taken as near the cutting edge as practicable. Any sample cutter failing to pass the hardness test shall be rejected, and if the number of defectives exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.3.2 *Performance test.* Each of the sample wire-rope cutters shall be tested as specified in 4.3.2.1 through 4.3.2.7.

4.3.2.1 *Type I, classes* 1 *and* 2. Type I, classes 1 and 2 cutters shall cut three pieces of plow steel wire-rope of the maximum size specified for the applicable cutter. Also, one of the samples shall be required to cut an additional 20 pieces of plow steel wire rope of the maximum size specified for the applicable cutter.

4.3.2.2 *Type II, class* 1. Type II, class 1 cutters shall cut three pieces of plow steel wire-rope of the maximum size specified for the applicable cutter.

4.3.2.3 *Type II, class* 2. Type II, class 2 cutters shall cut 12 complete strands from 1-1/4-inch diameter plow steel wire-rope.

4.3.2.4 *Type III.* Type III cutters shall cut three pieces of plow steel wire-rope of the maximum size specified for the applicable cutter. Also, one of the samples shall be required to cut an additional 12 pieces of plow steel wire rope of the maximum size specified for the applicable cutter except that 5/8 inch shall be used in lieu of 1 inch for the size No. 1 cutter in making the additional 12 cuts.

4.3.2.5 Performance of cutters shall show no excessive rounding, chipping, or the edge turning over on cutting blades which renders the cutter unsatisfactory for further severing of wire rope. All components shall function properly and show no evidence of damage. Type I, class 1; type I, class 2, style A; and type II, class 1, style B cutters shall meet the time cycle of operation specified in 3.12.1.5, 3.12.2.1.5, and 3.13.1.2.5, respectively. Type I, class 1; type I, class 2, style A; and type III cutters shall make clean cuts without appreciable deformation of the wire rope. Any sample cutter failing to pass the performance tests shall be rejected, and if the number of defectives exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.3.2.6 *Proof test.* One cutter assembly of the following: Type I, class 1 (3.12.1.1), type I, class 2, style A, design a and b (3.12.2.1.1), type I, class 2, style B, design a and b (3.12.2.2.1) or type II, class 1, style B, as applicable, shall be selected from each lot and tested to determine compliance with load requirements specified in applicable paragraphs. Any departure from specified requirements shall constitute a defect and be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.3.2.7 Select one cutter assembly from each lot of type I cutter assemblies and test to determine compliance with requirements specified in 3.5. Any departure from specified requirements shall constitute a defect and be cause for rejection of the lot.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For Civil agency procurement, Fed. Std. No. 102 should be referred to for definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging protection for supplies and equipment.)

5.1 Preservation and packaging.

5.1.1 *Level A.* Level A cleaning, preservation and packaging shall be in accordance with level A of MIL-H-15424.

5.1.2 *Level C.* Level C cleaning, preservation and packaging shall be in accordance

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

with the contractor's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 *Level A.* Level A packing shall be in accordance with level A of MIL-H-15424

5.2.2 *Level B.* Level B packing shall be in accordance with level B of MIL-H-15424.

5.2.3 *Level C.* Cutters cleaned, preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination. Containers shall be in accordance with the rules or regulations of carriers as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, each unit and intermediate package and shipping container shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.* Interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-H-15424.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.

6.1.1 Type I, class 1, and type I, class 2, style A hydraulic wire-rope cutters are used for general purpose cutting of wire ropes. They are especially satisfactory where lightness of weight, portability, ease, speed, and safety of operation are important. Type I, class 2, style B cutters are for heavy duty cutting of wire-rope up to 2-1/2 inches diameter and round bars of mild steel up to 1-5/8 inches diameter. They produce clean, straight cuts, are easy and safe to operate and require a minimum of maintenance.

6.1.2 Type II, class 1, style A mechanical wire-rope cutters are for mounting on a bench or other support and are used for general purpose wire-rope cutting of sizes up through 1-1/4 inches diameter.

6.1.3 Type II, class 1, style B mechanical wire-rope cutters are for general purpose cutting of wire rope up to 2-1/4 inches diameter and mild steel bars up to 1-1/4 inches diameter, and are mounted on three wheels for mobility.

6.1.4 Type II, class 2 mechanical cutters are primarily for clipping off complete strands of wire rope after splicing operations. The blades are designed for flush or close cutting.

6.1.5 Type III, wire-rope cutters are for general purpose cutting of wire ropes where a firm support or foundation and a sledge or heavy hand hammer are available.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Type, class, style, design, and size, if applicable, of cutter required (see 1.2 and applicable table).

(*c*) Finish, if other than specified, and particular color, if desired (see 3.9).

(*d*) If operating and service instruction sheets are not required, so specify (see 3.15).

(*e*) Whether preparation for domestic shipment—Immediate use; domestic shipment and storage; or overseas shipment is required (see section 5).

6.2.1 When ordering repair parts, specify the following:

(*a*) The manufacturer's name or trademark of cutter for which the parts are required.

(*b*) Name and quantity of part required.

(c) Capacity and model designation of the parent wire-rope cutter.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.3 Transportation description. Transportation description applicable to this item is:

Machines, not otherwise indexed by name. (Specify set-up or knocked down.)

Tools, not otherwise indexed by name (NOIBN)

Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Tools, hand, other than power

Truckload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Notice. When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise, as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army—GL

Navy—Ships

Air Force—MAMA

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.